Teaching Statement

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During my time as a PhD student, I have had the opportunity to gain practical experience of teaching. Over two years, I was the teaching assistant in econometrics for the MSc in Economics program at the Stockholm School of Economics. This involved preparing and giving weekly seminars, designing and grading problem sets and providing student-specific feedback. I greatly enjoyed this experience, and it allowed me to develop my own perspective on teaching.

Teaching philosophy

In my experience as both a teacher and a student, people often learn in two broad ways. Some begin with intuition and then move to technical detail—without intuition, the details feel arbitrary and are hard to remember. Others prefer to build systematically from fundamentals until a full picture emerges. In many cases this aligns with whether the student has a math background or not, presenting a challenge for teaching since economics students tend to vary greatly in this respect.

I see these modes of learning not as substitutes, but as complements. As a teacher, I frequently move back and forth between intuition and technical detail, linking each step to the goal (why are we doing this?) and the method (how are we getting there?). I have found that using visual aids, such as diagrams or even pictures, and practical examples in tandem with mathematics—rather than as take-aways or afterthoughts—help bridge these approaches. The goal of teaching, to me, is having students leave with equally strong intuition as technical proficiency.

Developing pedagogical course material is crucial to achieving this. Ahead of class, but also after, I would continuously update examples or explanations that seemed familiar and intuitive to *me*, but possibly not to others. A key part of this is sensing which students are in the classroom, and what backgrounds they come from.

Interacting with data

A key technical skill that varies widely among students, and, unfortunately, often becomes more uneven by the end of applied courses is programming and data analysis. In group work, students tend to specialize quickly, with those who have prior experience in coding or computing taking charge of the empirical tasks. By the end of the first course I taught, some students had never even opened a dataset. To address this, I required all students to submit code and results individually, even when working in groups. While nothing prevented them from submitting identical files, this ensured that everyone at least ran the code—a light-touch approach that ultimately made most students significantly more engaged in the empirical work.

I am excited about the prospect of teaching a wide range of courses at the undergraduate or graduate level in the future, and hope to keep learning and improving as a teacher when I do so.